The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

22nd January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Decisive (निर्णायक)

Meaning: Settling an issue; producing a definite result.
Synonyms: Conclusive, critical, definitive
Antonyms: Indecisive, hesitant, inconclusive
Example: The judge's decisive ruling brought an end to the prolonged legal battle.

2. Innately (स्वाभाविक रूप से)

Meaning: In a way that is inborn or natural.
Synonyms: Naturally, inherently, intrinsically
Antonyms: Artificially, externally, superficially
Example: He is innately talented in playing the piano, without any formal training.

VOCABULARY

3. Internecine (घातक/आपसी विनाशकारी)

Meaning: Destructive to both sides in a conflict.
Synonyms: Deadly, destructive, mutually harmful
Antonyms: Peaceful, cooperative, constructive
Example: The internecine feud within the organization led to its eventual collapse.

4. Remuneration (मुआवज़ा)

Meaning: Money paid for work or a service.
Synonyms: Compensation, payment, reward
Example: The employees demanded fair remuneration for their overtime work.

VOCABULARY

5. Eminent (प्रख्यात)

Meaning: Famous and respected within a particular sphere.
Synonyms: Notable, distinguished, renowned
Antonyms: Unknown, obscure, insignificant
Example: The eminent scientist gave a lecture on his groundbreaking research in the field of physics.

6. Imminent (निकट होने वाला)

Meaning: About to happen; impending.
Synonyms: Approaching, forthcoming, impending
Antonyms: Distant, remote, far-off
Example: The imminent arrival of the storm prompted authorities to issue warnings.

VOCABULARY

7. Conjecture (अनुमान)

Meaning: An opinion or conclusion formed on the basis of incomplete information.
Synonyms: Guess, speculation, assumption
Example: The scientist's conjecture about the cause of the disease was based on limited evidence.

8. Vehement (उग्र)

Meaning: Showing strong feeling; forceful, passionate, or intense.
Synonyms: Fervent, intense, passionate
Antonyms: Indifferent, apathetic, calm
Example: She gave a vehement speech against the proposed law, emphasizing its flaws.

VOCABULARY

9. Irascible (चिड़चिड़ा)

Meaning: Easily angered; quick-tempered.
Synonyms: Irritable, short-tempered, petulant
Antonyms: Calm, patient, placid
Example: The irascible coach yelled at the players for making too many mistakes.

10. Precarious (संकटपूर्ण)

Meaning: Not securely held or in position; dangerously likely to fall or collapse.
Synonyms: Risky, unsafe, unstable
Antonyms: Secure, safe, stable
Example: The climbers found themselves in a precarious position on the narrow ledge.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs

1. Put off
Meaning: To delay or postpone something.

2. Get along (with)
Meaning: To have a friendly relationship with someone.

3. Carry on
Meaning: To continue doing something.

4. Set up
Meaning: To establish or arrange something; to start a business or organization.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Riding a High Horse

Meaning: to start talking angrily about something

2. Dark Horse

Meaning: an unexpected winner

3. Dog Days

Meaning: the hottest days of the summer

VOCABULARY

4. Black Sheep

Meaning: a disfavored or disreputable member of a group

5. Thinking outside the box

Meaning: to think differently

Article for Reading

Inaugural drama: On the 47th President of the U.S.

Republican Donald Trump has been sworn in as the 47th President of the U.S. after his decisive victory in the November 2024 election. He marked the start of his second innings with a slew of executive orders, actions and directives that set the tenor for his administration's policy agenda over the four years. Significant among these are the nearly 1,600 pardons issued to those prosecuted for their role in the riot at the U.S. Capitol in 2021, the U.S.'s exit from the Paris Climate Agreement and the World Health Organization, the ending of birthright citizenship, protected under the U.S. Constitution's 14th Amendment, for children of undocumented migrants and those on temporary visas, a proposed 100% tariff on BRICS nations — both of which could impact Indians considerably — and 25% tariff on Canada and Mexico from February 1, a declaration of national emergency on the U.S.'s southern border with Mexico, and reversing 78 executive orders and memoranda of his predecessor, Joe Biden.

Striking optics of Mr. Trump's swearing-in was the positioning of tech bosses Elon Musk, Jeff Bezos, Sundar Pichai, and Mark Zuckerberg, prompting speculation on whether the incoming administration would have shades of a de facto "oligarchy"; and Mr. Musk, who is heading the new government's efforts to reduce waste and inefficiencies, giving a crowd what appeared to resemble a Nazi salute. As it stands, however, some, if not most, of these executive orders will face legal challenges — the attempted reading down of the 14th Amendment has already been challenged in court. The note that the second Trump administration has struck in terms of its policy agenda appears to be innately hostile to the progressive agenda of the Democrats. To a considerable extent, that is to be expected, as the two parties diverge significantly on matters such as the economy, immigration and reproductive rights.

Yet, previous Republican governments have often sought to build bridges with Democratic colleagues in Congress and at the State level, to find bipartisan consensus in key policy areas rather than risk deadlock and internecine conflicts over policy design and resource allocation. In this instance, however, the federal government trifecta and a sympathetic Supreme Court stacked with conservatives might mean that the Trump team needs to rely even less on support from across the aisle than it did during the Trump first term. Further, Mr. Trump appears to be emboldened by the breadth of his election victory to allow unconventional, even bizarre, policy priorities to enter the proposed agenda, including ideas such as the takeover of the Panama Canal, threatening Denmark with a plan to takeover Greenland, and the prospect of travel bans for certain countries. Perhaps America is getting what it voted for.

Summary

Donald Trump has been inaugurated as the 47th U.S. President following his decisive win in the 2024 election, beginning his second term with sweeping executive actions. Key measures include pardoning individuals involved in the 2021 Capitol riots, withdrawing from the Paris Climate Agreement and the World Health Organization, ending birthright citizenship for certain groups, imposing high tariffs on BRICS nations, Canada, and Mexico, and declaring a national emergency on the U.S.-Mexico border. His administration's agenda starkly opposes Democratic policies and reflects a more unilateral approach, enabled by Republican control of the federal government and a conservative Supreme Court. Controversial and unconventional proposals, such as attempting to overturn the 14th Amendment, and considering a takeover of Greenland, signal a bold and divisive policy path, though many actions are likely to face legal challenges.

Tone

The tone of the passage is critical and foreboding, reflecting skepticism about the new administration’s actions and policies while emphasizing their contentious and polarizing nature.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
What inference can be made about Donald Trump's governance style in his second term based on the passage?

a) He is focused on building bipartisan consensus.
b) He aims to strengthen international collaborations.
c) He seeks to push an agenda emboldened by a strong electoral mandate.
d) He prioritizes traditional Republican policies without deviation.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What tone does the passage adopt toward Donald Trump's second term policy agenda?

a) Optimistic about its potential for economic growth.
b) Critical of its unconventional and divisive nature.
c) Neutral, with a focus on presenting facts.
d) Enthusiastic about its focus on national security.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
What is suggested about the relationship between the Trump administration and technology leaders?

a) The administration may involve them in governance, raising concerns about oligarchy.
b) Technology leaders are expected to oppose Trump's policies.
c) Technology leaders have been excluded from discussions on reducing inefficiencies.
d) Their role is primarily symbolic in Trump's second term.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

A sweet win for turmeric farmers

This year’s Sankranti brought joy to turmeric farmers in Telangana as their nearly two-decade demand for a National Turmeric Board (NTB) became a reality. Union Minister Piyush Goyal inaugurated the Board, headquartered in Nizamabad, a major turmeric cultivation hub along the Godavari river. The Board aims to boost exports of 30 turmeric varieties grown across 20 States, including Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Andhra Pradesh. It will focus on research, product development, and leveraging turmeric’s medicinal value for global markets. In 2023-24, India cultivated turmeric on 3.05 lakh hectares, producing 10.74 lakh tonnes, with Telangana playing a significant role. India accounts for 70% of global production, exporting 1.62 lakh tonnes worth $226.5 million in the same period. The demand for a Board dates back to 2006, championed by the Telangana Turmeric Farmers Association and farmer welfare groups. Although a Turmeric Research Station was set up in 2007, farmers continued pressing for a Board to improve farming technologies, value addition, and remuneration.

The issue gained political momentum during the 2019 elections when BJP's Dharmapuri Arvind won the Nizamabad seat, promising to establish the Board. However, delays and political debates followed, with the BJP, Congress, and BRS contesting claims over the Board's establishment. Ahead of the 2023 Telangana elections, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the Board's creation, with a gazette formalizing it in October. The NTB's sudden inauguration has politically boosted the BJP, though Congress has called for broader farmer support, including marketing systems, cold storage, and a Minimum Support Price (MSP). Farmers emphasize the need for robust infrastructure, adequate funding, and MSP to stabilize prices, which have fluctuated between ₹15,000 and ₹18,000 per quintal last year to ₹10,000 currently. They suggest integrating the Kammarpally Research Centre with the NTB. To fulfill its purpose, the Board requires a strong budget, infrastructure, and close monitoring in its initial phase to meet farmers' expectations.

Question 4:
What role did the Kammarpally Research Centre play in the context of turmeric cultivation?

a) It replaced the need for a National Turmeric Board.
b) It provided the foundation for turmeric farming technologies.
c) It was the only government initiative supporting turmeric farmers before the NTB.
d) It led to significant price stabilization for turmeric farmers.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
What are the key challenges faced by turmeric farmers despite the establishment of the NTB?

a) Lack of awareness about turmeric's medicinal value in global markets.
b) Fluctuating prices, lack of infrastructure, and absence of MSP.
c) Decreased production due to unfavorable weather conditions.
d) Competition from international turmeric producers.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

Original Text: Sports tourism is a rapidly growing segment of the global travel industry, where individuals travel to engage in, spectate, or celebrate sports-related activities. It encompasses a wide range of experiences, from attending major international events like the Olympics or FIFA World Cup to participating in amateur marathons or adventure sports. This unique blend of sports and travel not only offers participants excitement but also significantly contributes to local economies and cultural exchange. Sports tourism is often categorized into three types: event-based tourism, active participation, and nostalgia tourism. Event-based tourism revolves around large-scale sporting events that attract spectators worldwide. Active participation involves travelers who engage in sports activities themselves, such as skiing in the

Alps or scuba diving in the Maldives. Nostalgia tourism includes visits to iconic sports landmarks or museums, such as cricket stadium tours or the Basketball Hall of Fame.

The impact of sports tourism extends beyond economic benefits. It fosters international camaraderie, promotes health and fitness, and encourages infrastructure development in host regions. For instance, hosting a global sports event often leads to the construction of stadiums, hotels, and transport facilities, which benefit local communities long after the event concludes.

However, sports tourism also faces challenges such as environmental concerns and issues of sustainability. Large gatherings can strain local resources, while the carbon footprint of travel and event organization can be significant. Addressing these challenges requires thoughtful planning, including eco-friendly practices, sustainable tourism policies, and community involvement to ensure long-term benefits.

Precis

Sports tourism, blending travel and sports, encompasses attending global events, participating in activities like skiing or diving, and exploring iconic sports landmarks. It boosts local economies, fosters cultural exchange, and promotes health and fitness. Categorized into event-based, active participation, and nostalgia tourism, it drives infrastructure development and global camaraderie.

Despite its benefits, sports tourism poses challenges, including environmental strain, resource depletion, and carbon emissions from travel. Sustainable practices, eco-friendly policies, and community involvement are essential to ensure long-term benefits while preserving resources for future generations.

- **You are the Sales Manager of a software company. Write an email to a prospective client, introducing your company's latest product and highlighting its features. Invite the client for a demonstration.**

To: ….@gmail.com

Subject: Discover [Product Name]: Your Solution for [Key Benefit]

Dear [Client's Name],

I’m [Your Name], Sales Manager at [Your Company Name]. We recently launched [Product Name], designed to [briefly highlight the benefit, e.g., simplify workflows, enhance efficiency]. Key features include:

[Feature 1] – [Benefit]
[Feature 2] – [Benefit]
[Feature 3] – [Benefit]
We’d love to show you how [Product Name] can benefit your business. Can we schedule a quick demonstration at your convenience?

Looking forward to your response.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
Sales Manager
[Your Company Name]

Match the column

1. Riding a High Horse	A. a disfavored or disreputable member of a group
2. Dark Horse	B. to start talking angrily about something
3. Dog Days	C. to think differently
4. Black Sheep	D. an unexpected winner
5. Thinking outside the box	E. the hottest days of the summer

Answer:

1-b

2-d

3-e

4-a

5-c

Vocabulary

1. Decisive:
2. Innately:
3. Internecine:
4. Remuneration:
5. Eminent:
6. Imminent:
7. Conjecture:
8. Vehement:
9. Irascible:
10. Precarious:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage notes Trump’s decisive election victory and describes how he has been emboldened to pursue unconventional and controversial policies, reflecting a strong electoral mandate.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) Incorrect: The passage highlights the lack of bipartisan efforts in this administration.
b) Incorrect: Policies like exiting the WHO and imposing tariffs suggest a reduction in international collaboration.
d) Incorrect: His proposed agenda includes unconventional and bizarre ideas, deviating from traditional Republican norms.

2.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage critiques several aspects of Trump's agenda, such as the "bizarre" policy proposals and potential hostility to Democratic priorities, indicating a critical tone.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) Incorrect: The passage does not emphasize economic growth positively.

c) Incorrect: While factual, the tone leans critical, not neutral.

d) Incorrect: National security policies are not highlighted positively.

3.

Ans: a

Explanation:

The passage highlights the presence of tech leaders like Elon Musk and Jeff Bezos at Trump’s swearing-in, prompting speculation about potential oligarchic influences.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

b) Incorrect: There is no suggestion that technology leaders oppose Trump’s policies.
c) Incorrect: Musk is described as leading efforts to reduce inefficiencies, not excluded.
d) Incorrect: Their roles are portrayed as substantive, not merely symbolic.

4.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage mentions the Kammarpally Research Centre (Turmeric Research Station) set up in 2007, aimed at improving farming technologies, though it did not fulfill the broader demands of farmers.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) The Centre did not replace the need for the NTB, as farmers continued to demand it.
c) While it was an initiative, it was not sufficient for farmers' expectations.
d) The Centre is not linked to price stabilization.

5.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage outlines the challenges, including fluctuating prices (₹15,000-₹18,000 per quintal dropping to ₹10,000), need for robust infrastructure, and the demand for MSP.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) The NTB aims to leverage turmeric's medicinal value, but awareness is not cited as a key challenge.

b) Production issues are not mentioned.

d) India dominates the global market with 70% production; competition is not noted.

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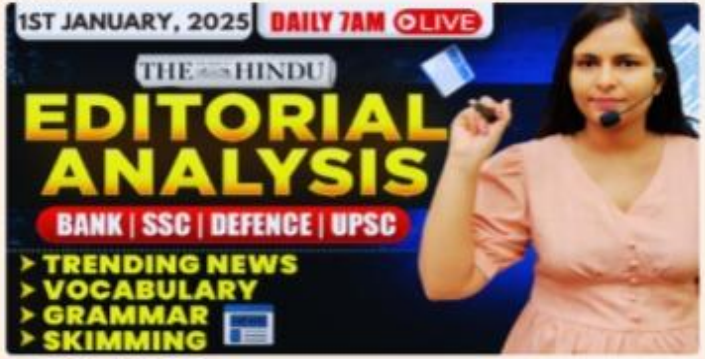

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